Assignment Briefs

OTHM Level 4 Diploma in Early Childhood Education

Qualification Number: 610/4873/2

OTHM Level 5 Diploma in Early Childhood Education

Qualification Number: 610/4872/0

OTHM Level 5 Extended Diploma in Early Childhood Education

Qualification Number: 610/4867/7

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ASSESSMENT GUIDANCE FOR CRITERION REFERENCED MARKING

The assessment grading criteria characterises the level of complexity and demand expected of students at each level of qualification. Please note that these are generic descriptors which apply mainly, though not exclusively, to written academic work.

Any further unit-specific assessment criteria, such as number of words, should be clearly stated in each individual assignment brief.

Result.	Level 3	Level 4	Level 5	Level 6	Level 7
Pass	Detailed answers to all parts of the questions or tasks. Clearly structured and focused, demonstrating overall coherence and in-depth understanding of the unit content and assessment requirements. Evidence of the use of independently sourced material, well applied in all contexts. Very few errors in grammar as appropriate.	Detailed response to all relevant parts of the questions or tasks, with evidence of clear understanding of the issues. Well-structured with evidence of independent reading supporting the argument. Clear evidence of a range of independently sourced material, well applied in all contexts. Very few errors in referencing or grammar or syntax as appropriate.	Very full, independent response to the assignment, applying relevant material well beyond any module input, demonstrating independent study. Excellent understanding and application of relevant theory, concepts and models. Very clear logical structure. Very few errors in referencing or grammar or syntax as appropriate.	Excellent links between relevant ideas, theories and practice. Evidence of independent learning and the ability to engage critically and analytically with a wide range of contextually relevant resource material. Demonstration of original insights supported by well structured overall argument. Very few errors in referencing or grammar or syntax as appropriate.	The work demonstrates engagement in an academic debate which presents clear evidence of a considered understanding of the topics studied. There is evidence of clear synthesis of theoretical issues and practice. A critical analysis of theoretical models and/or practical applications has resulted in originality. Very few errors in referencing or grammar or syntax as appropriate.

Fail	Little attempt to engage with assignment brief. Learning outcomes not fully met. Inadequate demonstration of knowledge or understanding of key concepts, theories or practice.	Little attempt to engage with assignment brief. Learning outcomes not fully met. Inadequate demonstration of knowledge or understanding of key concepts, theories or practice.	Little attempt to engage with assignment brief. Learning outcomes not fully met. Inadequate demonstration of knowledge or understanding of key concepts, theories or practice.	Little attempt to engage with assignment brief. Learning outcomes not fully met. Inadequate demonstration of knowledge or understanding of key concepts, theories or practice.	Whilst some of the characteristics of a pass have been demonstrated, the work does not address each of the outcomes for the specified assessment task. The work may be an overly descriptive account demonstrating minimal interpretation, and there is very limited evidence of analysis, synthesis or evaluation. No counterarguments or alternative frames of reference are generated or considered.

LEVEL 4 ASSIGNMENT BRIEFS

LEARNING AND DEVELOPMENT THROUGH PLAY

Unit Reference Number	L/651/3765

Unit Title	Learning and Development Through Play
Unit Level	4
Number of Credits	20
Total Qualification Time (TQT)	200
Guided Learning Hours (GLH)	100
Mandatory / Optional	Mandatory
Sector Subject Area (SSA)	01.5 Child development and well-being
Unit Grading Structure	Pass / Fail

Unit Aims

This unit emphasises learning and development through play. Adults play a crucial role in encouraging children to think independently and solve problems. Learners explore how to create meaningful play experiences for children. The focus is on promoting quality and age-appropriate activities that enhance learning.

Learning Outcomes – The learner will:	Assessment Criteria – The learner can:
1. Understand how play and learning activities promote children's learning and development	1.1 Outline theoretical perspectives of learning and development in early childhood 1.2 Summarise the different types of play 1.3 Explain the stages of children's play 1.4 Analyse the impact of play deprivation on children's learning and development. 1.5 Evaluate the benefits of different types of play and learning activities for children's learning and development at the following stages: ● Birth to 2 years ● 2 years to 5 years ● 5 years to 8 years
2. Understand curriculum approaches to outdoor play	2.1 Identify key theorists and their key approaches 2.2 Critique key theories of outdoor play 2.3 Explain key theorists influence on current outdoor play and learning practices 2.4 Analyse the risks and benefits for children in relation to outdoor play and learning
3. Understand how to support purposeful play	3.1 Identify and summarise the requirements of the UN Convention on the Rights of the Child in relation to relaxation and play 3.2 Explain the professional skills required to support purposeful play and learning 3.3 Analyse how play be organised to promote learning 3.4 Evaluate the role of the adult in supporting play

Assessment

To achieve a 'pass' for this unit, learners must provide evidence to demonstrate that they have fulfilled all the learning outcomes and meet the standards specified by all assessment criteria.

Learning Outcomes to be met	Assessment Criteria to be covered	Assessment type	Word count (approx. length)
LO1-LO3	All ACs under LO1-LO3	Coursework	3500 words

Scenario

Read through the following case study:

Tim is a curious and energetic 4-year-old who attends the Bright Beginnings Early Learning Centre. Before the pandemic, Tim thrived in a play-rich environment, exploring the world through various types of play. However, when COVID-19 arrived, everything changed**.** Before the pandemic Tim loved the sensory table, where they could squish playdough, pour water, and explore different textures, however during lockdowns Tim's play became more solitary, and played alone in his room. This shift likely resulted from the sudden disruption of routines, limited social interactions, and increased anxiety. When the parks reopened Tim played alongside other children but rarely with them and didn't want to share his toys. Back at Bright Beginnings as pandemic restrictions eased, Tim started to join in games in the outdoor play area and cooperative play allowed Tim and his friends to collaborate, negotiate rules and build friendships again. During the pandemic Tim's anxiety had increased and had disrupted his emotional regulation, Zoom playdates had helped but Tim had missed cooperative play, and it had impacted his cognitive growth.

Task 1 of 1

Unit Learning Outcome	**Assessment Criteria**
LO1. Understand how play and learning activities promote children's learning and development	1.1, 1.2, 1.3, 1.4, 1.5
LO2 Understand curriculum approaches to outdoor play	2.1, 2.2, 2.3, 2.4
LO3 Understand how to support purposeful play	3.1, 3.2, 3.3, 3.4

Assignment Brief and Guidance

You are tasked with writing a **report** under the following headings about Tim's transition back to Bright Beginnings.

You may wish to use the following subheadings to help structure your report

- Theoretical Perspectives of learning and Development
- Types of Play and Their Benefits
- Stages of Play and Play Deprivation
- Parental Involvement and supporting purposeful play and the UN Convention on the Rights of the Child

You are required to cover the following AC's within your report:

1.1 Outline theoretical perspectives of learning and development in early childhood
1.2 Summarise the different types of play
1.3 Explain the stages of children's play
1.4 Analyse the impact of play deprivation on children's learning and development.
1.5 Evaluate the benefits of different types of play and learning activities for children's learning and development at the following stages:

- Birth to 2 years

- 2 years to 5 years
- 5 years to 8 years

2.1 Identify key theorists and their key approaches
2.2 Critique key theories of outdoor play
2.3 Explain key theorists influence on current outdoor play and learning practices
2.4 Analyse the risks and benefits for children in relation to outdoor play and learning
3.1 Identify and summarise the requirements of the UN Convention on the Rights of the Child in relation to relaxation and play
3.2 Explain the professional skills required to support purposeful play and learning
3.3 Analyse how play be organised to promote learning
3.4 Evaluate the role of the adult in supporting play

Delivery and Submission

The submission should be in the form of a report written in Word format.
The recommended word limit is **3500** words excluding diagrams, references, and appendices.

Referencing

You are expected to use relevant academic and reliable sources, and clearly reference these in your work.
Citations should be added to the text and placed at the end in a reference list, using the Harvard referencing style.